RESPONDING TO STUDENTS ENGAGED IN BULLYING BEHAVIOURS

Response Continuum

	Tier 1 — Universal prevention and early response	Tier 2 — Targeted support and intervention	Tier 3 — Intensive, individualised and coordinated response
1. Safety, reporting and immediate response	☐Accessible, age-appropriate reporting pathways ☐Clear staff response procedures and responsibilities ☐Prompt acknowledgement of reports ☐Immediate assessment of safety and ongoing risk ☐Active supervision in identified locations ☐Clear expectations and proportionate consequences ☐Protection from retaliation ☐Regular review of incident and location data (i.e. PBL/SORD))	☐Individual reporting system/process or nominated contact (authorized environment) ☐Scheduled follow-up with affected students ☐Individual safety and support plan (ISP/IBSP) where required ☐Targeted monitoring of classes, breaks, transport and transitions (and online interactions if required) ☐Identified safe locations and staff contacts ☐Arrival, departure and transition check-ins ☐Communication plan across relevant staff (i.e. “at a glance or email thread) ☐Pattern analysis of frequency, location, peers, triggers and impact AND Short-cycle review of whether harm has stopped ☐Short-term or mid-term case meeting to align responses where required	☐Comprehensive risk and safety plan (ISP/IBSP) ☐Immediate senior leadership oversight and case management ☐Supervised arrival, departure, movement and transitions (separations where safety is concerned) ☐Timetable, class, transport or playground-zone changes (separations where safety is concerned) ☐Police, Child Safety or emergency engagement where thresholds are met ☐Formal multi-agency safety planning ☐Planned reintegration after suspension
2. Positive school culture, belonging and protective experiences	☐Intentionally build Positive and Benevolent Childhood Experiences ☐Every student connected to at least one trusted adult ☐Explicit norms for inclusion, safety and respect ☐Consistent welcome, recognition and positive feedback routines ☐Student voice and participation ☐Inclusive clubs, teams, cultural groups and lunchtime activities (appropriate to school context) ☐Strengths-based opportunities for success and contribution ☐Whole-school belonging and engagement strategies ☐Culturally responsive practice and visible representation	☐Daily or scheduled Check In/Check Out (regular wellbeing conversations) ☐Trusted adult, mentor or year-level contact ☐Supported entry into a club, team or structured activity ☐Intentional positive contact with home ☐Individual belonging and engagement goals ☐Planned opportunities for safe peer success ☐Targeted cultural, identity or community connection	☐Intensive case management ☐Wraparound planning with family and agencies ☐Re-engagement plan following disengagement or suspension ☐Intensive cultural or community liaison support ☐Alternative or flexible engagement options – I.e. Supported Play, Intervention, 1:1 Learning Support, etc. ☐Brokerage for therapeutic programs
3. Explicit teaching and social-emotional skill development	☐Explicit teaching of respectful relationships – RRE Program ☐Clear teaching about bullying, conflict, teasing and aggression – Whole school, cohort, class ☐Social Emotional Learning programs (School designed or purchased such as Berry Street, The Resilience Project, You can do it!, Smiling Mind, Wellio, etc.) ☐Digital citizenship and safe online conduct – Integrated into Dig Technology/Dig Lit programs	☐Individual or small-group teaching of identified skill gaps (SEL groups) ☐Teaching repair, apology and restitution – Restorative Practice ☐Emotional regulation and impulse-control instruction (ZoR) ☐Pre-correction before predictable high-risk situations – Connected to Check in processes ☐Conflict-resolution and problem-solving skill programs (i.e. Rock and Water, RAGE)	☐Intensive individual skills program informed by assessment ☐Individual curriculum addressing harmful relational or coercive behaviour ☐Repeated practice across settings with adult coaching ☐Functional communication and replacement-skill teaching ☐Therapeutic intervention for complex mental health or trauma needs ☐Specialist sexual behaviour support where relevant ☐Intensive digital-safety planning and education ☐General planning across home, school and community – Case meeting cycles
4. Environment, supervision and opportunity reduction	☐Active and visible staff supervision ☐Mapping of bullying hotspots and vulnerable times (SORD Behaviour Dashboard or PBL) ☐Predictable classroom and playground routines ☐Clear physical and digital behaviour expectations ☐Thoughtful seating, grouping and transitions ☐Staff presence during arrival, departure and movement ☐Safe use of toilets, change rooms and shared spaces ☐Structured options during breaks	☐Individual seating and grouping plan ☐Structured lunch break plan ☐Supported transitions between classes or locations ☐Staggered movement or adjusted access ☐Increased supervision during identified high-risk times ☐Planned access to a regulation or reset space ☐Temporary adjustment to devices, platforms or group chats ☐Reduced unstructured contact	☐Class, subject, timetable, transport or playground changes ☐Individual escort or direct handover arrangements ☐Highly structured learning and break schedule (individual timetable) ☐Intensive adult supervision plan ☐Restricted contact arrangements consistent with policy and rights ☐Environmental assessment by specialist personnel ☐Formal review before reducing protective arrangements

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5. Individual behaviour assessment, planning and accountability	☐Consistent implementation of the Student Code of Conduct ☐Clear and consistent consequences and rewards ☐Classroom rules and expectations ☐Consistent documentation (OneSchool) ☐ Staff calibration about minor, major and bullying behaviours	☐Individual behaviour goals and progress monitoring ☐Behaviour support or targeted support plan (IBSP) ☐Functional behavior assessment (FBA) ☐Analysis of ABC data ☐Escalation mapping (behaviour escalation map) ☐Check In/Check Out linked to expectations - Explicit discussion of behaviour, impact, consequence and future choices	☐Individual Behaviour Support Plan developed by a multidisciplinary team (IBSP) ☐Formal case manager and scheduled reviews (Complex Case Management) ☐Specialist behaviour, inclusion or disability consultation (external) ☐Post-suspension re-entry plan
6. Disability adjustments	☐Differentiated and engaging teaching and learning ☐Reasonable adjustments based on functional need ☐Universal Design for Learning ☐Explicit instruction and clear success criteria ☐Predictable routines and manageable task demands ☐Communication supports and visual prompts	☐Individual task, seating, grouping and work arrangements ☐Reduce cognitive or sensory overload during high-risk periods ☐Communication scripts, visual supports and social narratives ☐Supported peer interaction and structured group roles ☐Targeted literacy, learning or executive-function intervention ☐Planned movement, sensory or regulation breaks ☐Individualised engagement and success goals ☐Consult HOSES, inclusion staff or specialist teachers	☐Review of disability adjustments and access – Documented in PLR and support provisions ☐Specialist assessment of communication, sensory, executive-function or learning needs ☐Autism and other specialist advisory support ☐Individualised timetable, curriculum or environment ☐Coordinated NDIS-provider consultation within boundaries ☐Review verification, resourcing or specialist support needs ☐Regional inclusion or complex-case support
7. Wellbeing, mental health and student support services	☐Whole-school wellbeing program ☐Access to school wellbeing staff ☐Processes for the identification of anxiety, trauma, grief, identity or peer concerns ☐Clear referral pathways	☐Guidance Officer consultation or referral ☐School-based youth health, wellbeing or chaplaincy support Individual emotional regulation or coping plan (recorded as a support provision) ☐Targeted counselling (i.e. School-based Psychologist or GO referral) ☐Frequent positive wellbeing checks ☐Referral to GP or community health ☐Collaborative planning with treating professionals, with consent	☐Immediate wellbeing or mental health assessment where risk is elevated (Engage with GP) ☐Suicide/self-harm procedures (Safety planning) ☐CYMHS, Headspace, paediatric, psychological or psychiatric engagement ☐Coordinated school–health case planning (linking in school health personal) ☐Substance-use or youth-justice support where relevant
8. Family partnership and capability building	☐Positive contact not limited to incidents ☐Clear explanation of expectations and processes ☐Clear reporting and complaint pathways ☐Shared language around bullying and conflict ☐Sharing ParentLine with school community	☐Scheduled contact and progress updates ☐Shared goals and consistent language across home and school ☐Parent-line referral ☐Support access to GP, allied health or community services	☐Dedicated school contact or case manager ☐Family and Child Connect or Intensive Family Support referral ☐Child Safety engagement ☐Cultural liaison, interpreter or community representative involvement ☐Brokerage for identified needs ☐Support for attendance, transport, housing or crisis factors
10. Cultural safety, identity and inclusion	☐Culturally responsive curriculum and practices ☐Accessible participation for students with disability ☐First Nations perspectives and community partnerships ☐Staff capability in bias and discrimination (where required) ☐Clear response to identity-based bullying and harassment ☐Safe mechanisms to raise cultural or identity concerns	☐Engage First Nations staff, liaison staff or community representatives ☐Targeted teaching addressing prejudice or discriminatory language	☐Regional First Nations, inclusion, multicultural or specialist advisory support ☐Intensive cultural safety planning ☐Community-led or culturally informed intervention ☐Multi-agency response to serious discrimination or exploitation ☐Intensive staff capability development
11. Leadership, systems, documentation and review	☐Clear schoolwide definition and response process ☐Staff professional learning and role clarity ☐Consistent OneSchool recording ☐Data review by behaviour, location, time, cohort and group (SORD or PBL) ☐Alignment with Student Code of Conduct ☐Confidential communication protocols (anonymous reporting system) ☐Leadership oversight of serious or repeated incidents	☐ Baseline measures and measurable goals ☐ Fidelity checks: were supports implemented? Has frequency, severity and impact reduced? (Line of sight)	☐Formal multidisciplinary case management ☐Complex case review with assigned actions ☐Brokerage referrals where appropriate ☐Cross-agency information sharing consistent with legislation